

Brick Title (as it will appear in the menu) : Countable & Uncountable nouns

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Menu	Sub-topic	KEYWORDS (for the search engine: 3-5 words)
☐ Everyday Communication ☐ Specialist Communication ☐ Professional Communication ☒ Learning Focus	☐ Existant created ☒ To be Grammar	Nouns Countable Uncountable

BRICK CONTENT

- One line in the table below = one step in the brick/learning path. If the pathway is to be differentiated according to student level (success rate in quizzes etc.), make sure the pre-requisite and progression is clearly signaled.
- The order of the steps can vary depending on the content of the brick, but try to be as consistent as possible
- Please DO NOT use .pdf as they cannot be easily integrated.

Brick content	Teacher's comments for David
 <u>Step 1: Introduction</u> LEARNING OBJECTIVES At the end of this brick, you will be able to: - Identify and distinguish countable from uncountable nouns - Use countable and uncountable nouns correctly in sentences, applying the right grammar rules CONTENT You will ... 1. Complete a short introductory activity on the topic 2. Watch a short video	

3. Practice key grammar using various types of exercises
4. Test your knowledge using a timed quiz
5. You can explore the subject further using the resources provided if you wish.

TIME: 30min

CEFR level: A2

Step 2: I start

There are 4 major word classes in English: nouns, adjectives, verbs and adverbs.
Nouns are divided into two categories: proper nouns and common nouns.

- **Proper nouns** refer to specific names of people, places, or things and always begin with a capital letter. (*William Shakespeare, Paris, Google...*)
- **Common nouns** refer to general items or ideas and are not capitalized unless they begin a sentence. (*man, city, company*)

In English, common nouns may be countable or uncountable. Complete the 2 steps below to learn more about them.

Step 1. [Drag and Drop.] Match each word to the correct picture.

Word	Picture
water	Picture
book	Picture
rice	Picture
banana	Picture
friend	Picture
apple	Picture
money	Picture
butter	Picture

Step 2: Look at the question and examples below. Then select the right answers in the chart.

Ask yourself: "Can I say: 1 [word] + 1 [word] + 1 [word]... = many [word]?"

- If yes → it's **countable**

- If no → it's **uncountable**

For example:

- friend > "Can I say: 1 friend + 1 friend + 1 friend... = many friends?"

Yes > the word "friend" is **countable**

- rice > "Can I say: 1 rice + 1 rice + 1 rice... = *many rices?"

No > the word "rice" is **uncountable**.

Word	Can I count it like this?	The noun is...
water	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable

David, on a
besoin
d'images ici

book	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
rice	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
banana	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
friend	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
apple	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
money	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable
butter	Yes / No	Countable / Uncountable

Step 3: I learn

I learn (option 3)
Video ("watch&listen")



Watch this video carefully and take notes.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4D6JErWRS9k>

Step 4: Summary

There are two types of nouns in English: **countable nouns** and **uncountable nouns**, just like in French.

Part 1: countable nouns

Countable nouns are things you can count. They can be used in both the **singular** and **plural** forms.

Examples: book, car, smartphone...

- *a book; Ø books or the books; 6 books; many books*
- *a car; 2 cars; several cars*
- *This smartphone is expensive. / These smartphones are expensive.*

Be careful with "people": it's countable, but does **not take -s** at the end when it's the plural of "person". → *1 person / 3 people*

Part 2: uncountable nouns

Uncountable nouns refer to things you **cannot count**. They are usually seen as **a whole** or a concept. **You shouldn't think of them as individual units.**

Common uncountable nouns in English:

- **Things seen as a whole:** furniture, luggage, hair, rubbish...
- **Materials and food:** wool, cotton, steel, milk, tea...
- **Abstract concepts:** advice, knowledge, news, information, evidence, progress, damage, work, business, research...

Grammar Rules for Uncountable Nouns

1. No -s at the end of uncountable nouns.

Examples: *my luggage / their advice / the information / his knowledge of philosophy*

2. Use a singular verb for uncountable nouns.

Examples:

- My luggage **is** upstairs.

- This information **is** very important. It **comes** from management.

3. Do not use "a" or "an" before uncountable nouns.

To count them, you can use "**a piece of...**" : *a piece of information, a piece of news, a piece of luggage...*

Or use an expression specific to the noun: *a loaf of bread, a fit of madness, a peal of laughter...*

Compare:

a piece of information = one single fact	information (no "s") = multiple facts
a piece of advice = one suggestion	advice (no "s") = several suggestions
a piece of news = one bit of news	news = multiple news items (still singular in English)

4. Quantifiers (words that indicate quantity) may change depending on whether the noun is countable or uncountable.

For this, see the brick on quantifiers.

French:

Il existe deux types de noms en anglais : les noms **dénombrables** et les noms **indénombrables**, comme en français.

PARTIE I : LES NOMS DÉNOMBRABLES

Les noms **dénombrables** sont ceux que l'on peut compter / dénombrer.

Ils peuvent aussi bien s'accorder au pluriel qu'au singulier.

Ex. book, car, smartphone...

A book ; Ø books ou the books ; 6 books ; many books

A car ; 2 cars ; several cars

*This smartphone is expensive ; **These smartphones are expensive.***

Attention à **people** qui est dénombrable mais qui ne prend pas de « -s » lorsqu'il s'agit du pluriel de *person*.

PARTIE II: LES NOMS INDÉNOMBRABLES

Les noms **indénombrables** sont ceux que l'on ne peut pas compter / dénombrer. Ils sont en quelque sorte considérés comme des notions, des « tous ». Il ne faut donc pas chercher à les envisager comme des unités.

Par exemple, vous ne pouvez pas dire « un lait » ou « des laits » en français ; en anglais, c'est la même chose.

Ex : *Children drink milk. Les enfants boivent du lait. / Did you buy milk yesterday? Est-ce que tu as acheté du lait hier ?*

* ~~Did you buy 3 milks yesterday?~~ est impossible.

PARTIE III : DIFFÉRENCES ANGLAIS / FRANCAIS

Attention : certains mots en anglais sont indénombrables alors que ce n'est pas le cas en français.

L'exemple du mot « meuble » :

- en français, on peut dire « un meuble », « 2 meubles », « 10 meubles » ;
- en anglais, ce n'est pas possible car *furniture* est indénombrable : pour un anglophone, *furniture* a le même fonctionnement que *milk* donc ~~*a furniture~~, ~~*two furnitures~~, ~~*10 furnitures~~ sont impossibles. Qu'il y en ait un ou plusieurs, on dira *furniture*, qui fonctionne plutôt comme « mobilier » en français.

Les principaux indénombrables en anglais :

- Les noms qui renvoient à une entité : *furniture, luggage, hair, rubbish...*
- Certains matériaux et aliments : *wool, cotton, steel, milk, tea...*
- Certains noms abstraits : *advice (conseils), knowledge (connaissances), news (nouvelles), information, evidence (preuves), progress, damage, work, business, research...*

1. On ne peut pas ajouter un "s" à un nom indénombrable.

My luggage : mes bagages / Their advice : leurs conseils / The information : les informations / His knowledge of philosophy : ses connaissances en philosophie.

2. Les indénombrables sont toujours suivis d'un verbe au singulier.

My luggage is upstairs. Mes bagages sont à l'étage.

***This** information is very important. It directly comes from management. Ces informations*

sont très importantes. Elles proviennent directement de la direction.

En français, on a un nom pluriel et le verbe s'accorde au pluriel.

3. L'emploi de *a* ou *an* est interdit avant un nom indénombrable.

Si l'on souhaite les compter, il est possible d'utiliser l'expression « *a piece of* » avec les indénombrables (*a piece of information, a piece of news, a piece of luggage...*) ou d'ajouter un terme qui sera propre à chaque mot (*a loaf of bread, a fit of madness, a peal of laughter...*).

Notez la différence :

<i>A piece of information</i> : une information	<i>information</i> (sans « s ») : des informations
<i>A piece of advice</i> : un conseil	<i>advice</i> (sans « s ») : des conseils
<i>A piece of news</i> : une nouvelle	<i>news</i> : des nouvelles

4. Les quantifieurs (outils servant à indiquer une quantité) **seront parfois différents si le nom est dénombrable ou indénombrable**. Voir à ce sujet la leçon sur les quantifieurs.

Step 5: I practice



“Language work”

Exercise 1. Look at the list of words below. Click on the words that are uncountable.

[Reminder] Ask yourself: “Can I say: 1 [word] + 1 [word] + 1 [word] = many [word]?”

- If yes → it's countable

- If no → it's uncountable

Money / people / **water** / **news** / University course / **knowledge** / laptop / **information** / **furniture** / book / bag / **advice** / window / **luggage**

Réponses en gras

Exercise 2. True or False? Fill in the chart below.

	True	False
Uncountable nouns can take an -s at the end.		X
We use singular verbs after uncountable nouns.	X	

Réponses en gras

You can use “a” or “an” directly before uncountable nouns. To count uncountable nouns, you can say “a piece of...” plus the noun. “News” is always singular, even though it can refer to multiple pieces of information.	X X	X	
Exercise 3. Select the correct answer. 1. I took 4 (University) [<i>courses</i> / <i>course</i>] this semester. 2. My luggage [is are] still in Barcelona 3. I would like to drink [tea a tea]. 4. She bought new [furniture furnitures]. 5. Our knowledge [is are] limited. 6. That was a good [piece of advice advice]. 7. That’s a new [piece of information information].			Réponses en gras
Step 6: I say “Voicework” Pedagogical approach and technical possibilities to be confirmed Listen and repeat each sentence. Pay close attention to the 's' at the end of plural nouns when it is present. 1. This book is really good. 2. I bought three books on Saturday. 3. May is my favourite month. 4. I have been studying for six months. 5. My best friend is good at football. 6. I went to the party with three friends. 7. One day I will travel to Japan. 8. I have to wait 3 days for my exam results.			Audios à déposer sur le Cloud
Step 7: I do “Autonomy” You've now reached the end of this brick —congratulations! It's now time for the final test. You'll have X minutes to complete it, and only one attempt is allowed. Click here when you're ready to begin!			Réponses correctes à indiquer seulement une fois que tous les exercices sont terminés, avec affichage du score final. Temps : David, tu peux faire les exercices et nous dire

combien de
temps ça t'a
pris ?
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ve
Here :
insérer un
lien vers la
page
suivante (le
début du
test)

Exercise 1. Are the words below countable or uncountable? Fill in the chart.

Noun	Countable	Uncountable
Table	X	
Butter		X
Happiness		X
Phone	X	
Suitcase	X	
Information		X
Advice		X
Mirror	X	
Knowledge		X
Friend	X	

Réponses en
gras

Score /5 (0,5
par réponse
correcte)

Exercise 2. True or False? Fill in the chart below.

	True	False
Uncountable nouns cannot take an -s at the end.	X	
We use plural verbs after uncountable nouns.		X
You can use "a" or "an" directly before uncountable nouns.		X
To count uncountable nouns, you can say "a piece of..." plus the noun (without the "s" at the end).	X	
"News", "Information", "Advice" are always singular.	X	

Score /5

Exercise 3. Select the correct answer.

1. I have three [books|book] on my desk.
2. The news [is|are] very interesting today.
3. Can I have some [water|waters], please?
4. She gave me useful [advice|advices] last week.
5. We saw many [cars|car] on the highway.
6. There is a lot of [furniture|furnitures] in the room.
7. He needs more [information|informations] before deciding.
8. I bought two [bags|bag] of clothes yesterday.

Score /10

9. The team's progress[is are] impressive. 10. I would like a piece of [cake cakes] for dessert.	
Step 8: I share “groupclass” Write 6 sentences about your daily life: - 3 sentences with countable nouns - 3 sentences with uncountable nouns Be prepared to share your sentences with your classmates!	
Step 9: I want more [Video] Countable and uncountable nouns: food. A Mini English Lesson https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xnG57RzZolo [Video] Countable & Uncountable Nouns (with quantifiers) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YsagocS1wGo	
Step 10: Toolbox - Pronunciation: https://howjsay.com/ - Dictionary: https://www.wordreference.com/ - Dictionary US: https://www.merriam-webster.com/ - Dictionary UK: https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/	
Step 11: For teachers Writing and/or speaking: [Alone or in pairs] Ask students to find 5 objects around them (at home or in class). For each object, they say whether it is countable or uncountable and use it in a sentence. Writing: [Alone or in pairs] Ask students to write a short paragraph about their favorite meal or daily routine, making sure to include both countable and uncountable nouns correctly. Speaking: [In pairs or small groups] One student describes an object or substance without naming it, and others guess if it's countable or uncountable. Example: “You can drink it. It's usually hot.” (Answer: tea, uncountable)	